Extended essay: commentary for example essay			
DP subject: (Subject-focused essay)	**Mathematics**		
DP subjects: (Interdisciplinary essay)		Interdisciplinary framework:	
Topic:	**The Goat Problem**		
Research question:	**What is the surface area to which a goat has access ?**		
Assessment details			
Criterion:	Mark awarded:	Commentary: (Incorporating wording from the assessment criteria)	
A: Framework for the essay [Maximum possible mark: 6]	**3**	Topic is not clearly explained. The research question (RQ) is stated with no explanation and it is not clear how the student arrived at the RQ. It feels like the candidate has approached this the wrong way - perhaps being given an RQ, rather than choosing the topic he is most interested in. The research methods are not always communicated clearly. The structure is generally good, but no need to list basic formula (pages 6 – 8).	
B: Knowledge and understanding [Maximum possible mark: 6]	**4**	Relevant research materials used. Some relevant terminology and concepts used to demonstrate some understanding.	
C: Analysis and line of argument [Maximum possible mark: 6]	**4**	Analysis and line of argument are both partially effective. Communication is not clear, diagrams and reasoning are often unclear and hard to follow.	
D: Discussion and evaluation [Maximum possible mark: 8]	**4**	Limited discussion on significance of findings. Limited evaluation during the essay – 3 different formula found, but no attempt to check for consistency with a simple case. A surprising, and doubtful, relation between angles (top page 17) not verified or questioned at all.	
E: Reflection [Maximum possible mark: 4]	**2**	The reflections are mainly descriptive, but there are some evaluative examples and evidence of student growth.	
Total marks awarded	17/30		
Holistic comment on the essay:	Reading the first paragraph of the RPF, It seems a shame that the student wasn't encouraged to proceed with his/her rocket science idea. Surely this could have been narrowed down to a workable RQ for an EE		

	either Maths or Physics – or interdisciplinary in both subjects ? It is interesting also that the student calls this an 'exploration' (RPF paragraph 2) – it is doubtful whether the candidate was clear what the EE requirements and criteria were. Overall, this is more of a given maths problem solved (as an IA) than an EE.